result of over 20 years of civil war. In the capital Luanda, wealthy areas are crossed by streets and alleys with open sewers and there are daily power cuts, forcing the wealthier families to have private power generators. The buses and '*candogueiros*' (public transportation provided by vans) serve the poorest sectors of the population; they share the capital's chaotic streets with the luxury cars of rich families who have increasingly been living in closed condominiums. In the peripheral areas of the city and in the interior of the country, the situation is even more precarious due to the effects of the civil war and the consequent destruction of the infrastructure.

Mozambique, meanwhile, has been, during the last few years, the target of multilateral financial institutions, such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, to implement their liberal economic reforms. After independence and a 16-year civil war, the Mozambican state aims to grow the economy by increasing foreign investments through a development standard based on the export of primary goods, mainly minerals, the import of high value-added goods, and low diversification of the national industry. It is worth pointing out the great dependence on foreign aid to balance the budget. Its infrastructure is better than Luanda's. In Maputo there are more paved streets and basic sanitation and the supply services for power, water and internet are much better structured. The services available to Maputo's population and visitors are also more sophisticated and the city is not as expensive as Luanda.

In both countries, mainly in Angola which intends to become a regional power and leader (rivalling South Africa), the main question for the interviewees was the means available for economic diversification and sustaining economic development. In both contexts, foreign aid and technology transfer by cooperation and foreign investment policies are considered necessary but not sufficient to attain the longed-for 'modernisation leap'. Also, environmental issues were not visible as in the Western countries and its discussion has been overshadowed by the concerns about food security and industrial development.

New forms of South–South indebtedness and its consequences

Based on a quick process of economic growth, the accelerated exploration of its immense oil reserves and mainly taking advantage of easy international credit access, in particular from China, Angola has been increasing its capacity of negotiation and bargaining with European countries and multilateral financial bodies. The interviewees drew attention to the Chinese government loan to Angola in 2004 when it ceased to negotiate with the IMF and got loans from